EDIBLE CANDLES — THE GOURMET COLLECTION

♦ ♦ ♦

Complete Shopping Checklist

Everything You Need — Organized Before You Begin

♦

Your one-stop reference for gathering every ingredient, tool, and supply you'll need to create all 50 gourmet edible candle recipes.

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How to Use This Checklist

How to Use This Checklist

Quick guide to getting the most out of your shopping preparation.

This checklist is designed to save you time, money, and frustration. Instead of flipping through each recipe individually, we've compiled every ingredient, tool, and supply you'll need into organized categories so you can shop efficiently — whether you're stocking up for one recipe or all fifty.

Before You Shop

You don't need to buy everything at once. Start with the **Essential Base Ingredients** and the **Equipment & Tools** sections — these cover the foundation for nearly every recipe. Then add specialty items as you choose which recipes to tackle first.

Check Off as You Go

Print this guide and use the checkboxes next to each item. Items you already have at home can be checked off immediately, so your shopping list only includes what's truly missing.

Quantity Guidance

Each item includes notes on typical quantities needed. These are estimates for making 4–6 candles at a time. Scale up or down depending on your batch size.

Budget Planning

Use the blank Budget Planning Template on page 17 to estimate costs before you shop. Many base ingredients are pantry staples you may already own.

Seasonal Awareness

Some ingredients — especially fresh fruits, flowers, and herbs — vary by season. Check the Seasonal Shopping Notes on page 19 for substitution ideas.

Pro Tip: Shop in Phases

Phase 1: Base ingredients + equipment (covers all recipes).
Phase 2: Sweet collection ingredients (for dessert-style candles).
Phase 3: Savory collection ingredients (for herb & cheese candles).
Phase 4: Packaging & presentation (when you're ready to gift or sell).

Every item on this checklist is commonly available at grocery stores, craft shops, and baking supply retailers. We've avoided any exotic or hard-to-find ingredients — gourmet doesn't have to mean complicated.

Essential Base Ingredients

foundation of every edible candle — stock these first.

These are the core ingredients that appear across the majority of the 50 recipes. Whether you're making a sweet chocolate candle or a savory herb creation, you'll reach for these staples again and again.

> **Quality Matters**
> Since edible candles are a gourmet product, invest in the best quality you can afford for base ingredients. The difference between standard and premium butter, for example, is noticeable in both flavor and texture of the final candle.

Fats & Oils

- [ ] Unsalted butter — *1 lb minimum; European-style preferred for richness*
- [ ] Coconut oil (refined) — *16 oz; the primary "wax" for most candle bodies*
- [ ] Coconut oil (virgin/unrefined) — *8 oz; for recipes that benefit from coconut flavor*
- [ ] Cocoa butter — *8 oz; food-grade, for chocolate-based candles*
- [ ] Shea butter (food-grade) — *4 oz; used in select luxury candle bases*
- [ ] Vegetable shortening — *8 oz; backup binding agent*
- [ ] Extra virgin olive oil — *small bottle; for savory candle finishes*

Dairy & Cream

- [ ] Heavy whipping cream — *1 pint; for ganache-style candle bodies*
- [ ] Cream cheese (full fat) — *8 oz; for cheesecake-inspired candles*
- [ ] Mascarpone cheese — *8 oz; for Italian-inspired recipes*
- [ ] Sweetened condensed milk — *1 can (14 oz); for caramel and dulce de leche candles*
- [ ] Whole milk — *1 cup; occasional recipe component*

Sweeteners

- [ ] Granulated white sugar — *2 lbs; for caramel and sugar work*
- [ ] Powdered sugar (confectioners') — *1 lb; for smooth textures*
- [ ] Light brown sugar — *1 lb; for butterscotch and toffee notes*
- [ ] Honey (raw, unfiltered) — *12 oz; for honey-based candle bodies*
- [ ] Pure maple syrup — *8 oz; Grade A dark for strong flavor*
- [ ] Light corn syrup — *8 oz; prevents crystallization in sugar work*
- [ ] Agave nectar — *4 oz; vegan alternative sweetener*

Chocolate & Cocoa

- [ ] Dark chocolate chips/bars (60–70% cacao) — *12 oz*
- [ ] Milk chocolate chips/bars — *12 oz*
- [ ] White chocolate chips/bars — *12 oz*
- [ ] Unsweetened cocoa powder — *8 oz; Dutch-process preferred*
- [ ] Chocolate candy melts (various colors) — *for decorative coatings*

Thickeners & Binders

- [ ] Gelatin (unflavored, powdered) — *1 box; structural support for candle bodies*
- [ ] Agar-agar powder — *2 oz; vegan gelatin alternative*
- [ ] Cornstarch — *4 oz; for texture smoothing*
- [ ] Tapioca starch — *4 oz; alternative thickener*

Flavorings & Extracts

- [ ] Pure vanilla extract — *4 oz; the most-used flavoring*
- [ ] Almond extract — *2 oz*
- [ ] Peppermint extract — *2 oz*
- [ ] Lemon extract — *2 oz*
- [ ] Orange extract — *2 oz*
- [ ] Coconut extract — *2 oz*
- [ ] Rose water — *4 oz; for floral candles*
- [ ] Fine sea salt — *small container; flavor enhancer*

Important: "Food-Grade" Labels

Always verify that cocoa butter, shea butter, and any other specialty fat is labeled **food-grade**. Cosmetic-grade versions are NOT safe for consumption, even though they may look identical.

Sweet Collection Ingredients

Sweet Collection Ingredients

ything for dessert-inspired, fruity, and indulgent candle recipes.

The Sweet Collection covers roughly 30 of the 50 recipes, including chocolate truffles, fruit-infused creations, floral delights, and spiced holiday candles. You won't need every item for every recipe — scan the specific recipe you're making and check off only what applies.

Chocolate & Cocoa Specialties

- [ ] Ruby chocolate — *4 oz; for rose-tinted candles*
- [ ] Cacao nibs — *4 oz; for texture and decoration*
- [ ] Chocolate sprinkles / jimmies — *for decorative finishing*
- [ ] Chocolate hazelnut spread — *8 oz; for Nutella-style candles*
- [ ] White cocoa butter coloring (oil-based food coloring) — *set of 4+ colors*

Fruit & Citrus

- [ ] Freeze-dried strawberries — *2 oz; for strawberry candle layers*
- [ ] Freeze-dried raspberries — *2 oz; for berry-themed candles*
- [ ] Freeze-dried blueberries — *2 oz; for mixed berry recipes*
- [ ] Dried cranberries — *4 oz; for holiday and autumn candles*
- [ ] Candied orange peel — *4 oz; for citrus garnish*
- [ ] Lemon zest (fresh lemons, 3–4) — *for lemon candle recipes*
- [ ] Orange zest (fresh oranges, 2–3) — *for orange-infused candles*
- [ ] Passion fruit puree — *4 oz; frozen section or specialty aisle*
- [ ] Mango puree — *4 oz; for tropical candle recipes*
- [ ] Banana chips — *4 oz; for decoration and crumble layers*

Caramel, Toffee & Butterscotch

- [ ] Caramel sauce (jarred, quality brand) — *12 oz; for caramel swirl recipes*
- [ ] Dulce de leche — *8 oz; for Latin-inspired candles*
- [ ] Butterscotch chips — *8 oz; for butterscotch candle bodies*
- [ ] Toffee bits — *4 oz; for crunch and decoration*
- [ ] Golden syrup — *4 oz; for British-style toffee candles*

Nuts & Seeds (Sweet Applications)

- [ ] Almonds (whole, blanched) — *4 oz; for marzipan and almond candles*
- [ ] Almond flour / almond meal — *4 oz; for smooth nut-based bodies*
- [ ] Hazelnuts (whole, skinned) — *4 oz; for praline candles*
- [ ] Pistachios (shelled, unsalted) — *4 oz; for pistachio candles and garnish*
- [ ] Pecans — *4 oz; for praline and pecan pie candles*
- [ ] Shredded coconut (sweetened) — *4 oz; for coconut candle coating*
- [ ] Toasted coconut flakes — *4 oz; for decoration*
- [ ] Sesame seeds — *2 oz; for Asian-inspired sweet candles*

Floral & Aromatic

- [ ] Edible dried rose petals — *1 oz; for rose-scented candles*
- [ ] Edible dried lavender buds — *1 oz; for lavender candles*
- [ ] Edible dried chamomile flowers — *1 oz; for chamomile-honey candles*
- [ ] Edible dried hibiscus flowers — *1 oz; for tropical floral candles*
- [ ] Edible flower mix (for decoration) — *1 pack; for finishing touches*
- [ ] Edible gold leaf sheets — *small booklet; for luxury finishes*
- [ ] Edible silver leaf sheets — *small booklet; for elegant accents*

Spices & Warm Flavors

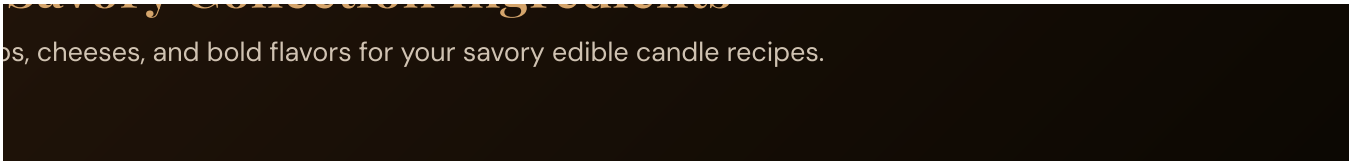
- [ ] Ground cinnamon — *2 oz; for spiced and holiday candles*
- [ ] Ground nutmeg — *1 oz; for warm, aromatic blends*
- [ ] Ground ginger — *1 oz; for gingerbread and chai candles*
- [ ] Ground cardamom — *1 oz; for exotic spice candles*
- [ ] Ground cloves — *1 oz; for holiday spice blends*
- [ ] Whole star anise — *small pack; for decoration and infusion*
- [ ] Whole cinnamon sticks — *small pack; for decoration*
- [ ] Pure vanilla bean (whole pods) — *2 pods; for premium vanilla candles*
- [ ] Matcha powder (culinary grade) — *2 oz; for green tea candles*
- [ ] Espresso powder / instant coffee — *2 oz; for coffee-flavored candles*
- [ ] Chai tea bags — *small box; for chai-spiced infusions*

Cookies, Crumbles & Extras

- [ ] Graham cracker crumbs — *4 oz; for cheesecake candle bases*
- [ ] Crushed Oreo-style cookies — *4 oz; for cookies & cream candles*
- [ ] Crushed digestive biscuits — *4 oz; for British-style bases*
- [ ] Peanut butter (smooth, natural) — *8 oz; for peanut butter candles*
- [ ] Marshmallow creme — *7 oz jar; for s'mores-style candles*
- [ ] Mini marshmallows — *4 oz; for decoration and hot chocolate candles*
- [ ] Sprinkles assortment (jimmies, nonpareils, confetti) — *for decoration*

> **Storage Tip**
> Freeze-dried fruits, edible flowers, and nut flours keep best in airtight containers in a cool, dark place. Chocolate should be stored at 60–70°F (15–21°C) away from direct sunlight to prevent blooming.

Savory Collection Ingredients



The Savory Collection covers approximately 20 recipes featuring herbs, cheeses, infused oils, and unexpected gourmet combinations. These candles are conversation starters at dinner parties and make unforgettable appetizer presentations.

Fresh Herbs

- [ ] Fresh rosemary — *1 bunch; for rosemary-infused candles*
- [ ] Fresh thyme — *1 bunch; for herb garden candles*
- [ ] Fresh basil — *1 bunch; for Italian-inspired candles*
- [ ] Fresh sage — *small bunch; for brown butter sage candles*
- [ ] Fresh mint — *1 bunch; for fresh herb candles*
- [ ] Fresh chives — *1 bunch; for onion-herb candles*
- [ ] Fresh dill — *small bunch; for Scandinavian-inspired recipes*

Dried Herbs & Spices (Savory)

- [ ] Dried oregano — *1 oz; for Mediterranean candles*
- [ ] Dried basil — *1 oz; backup for fresh*
- [ ] Herbes de Provence blend — *1 oz; for French-inspired candles*
- [ ] Italian seasoning blend — *1 oz; all-purpose herb mix*
- [ ] Smoked paprika — *1 oz; for smoky-flavored candles*
- [ ] Cracked black pepper — *whole peppercorns with grinder*
- [ ] Red pepper flakes — *1 oz; for spicy kick candles*
- [ ] Garlic powder — *2 oz; for garlic-herb recipes*
- [ ] Onion powder — *1 oz; for savory base notes*
- [ ] Cumin (ground) — *1 oz; for Middle Eastern-inspired candles*
- [ ] Za'atar blend — *2 oz; for Levantine-inspired candles*

Alliums & Aromatics

- [ ] Fresh garlic heads — *2–3; for roasted garlic candles*
- [ ] Shallots — *2–3; for French-style infusions*
- [ ] Sun-dried tomatoes (oil-packed) — *8 oz jar; for Mediterranean candles*
- [ ] Sun-dried tomatoes (dry) — *4 oz; for garnish and texture*
- [ ] Kalamata olives (pitted) — *6 oz; for olive tapenade candles*
- [ ] Green olives (pitted) — *6 oz; for cocktail-inspired candles*
- [ ] Capers — *2 oz jar; for briny, Mediterranean accents*
- [ ] Roasted red peppers (jarred) — *8 oz; for pepper-infused candles*

Cheeses

- [ ] Parmesan (Parmigiano-Reggiano), finely grated — *4 oz; for Italian candles*
- [ ] Aged cheddar, finely shredded — *4 oz; for cheddar-herb candles*
- [ ] Goat cheese (chèvre) — *4 oz; for tangy, creamy candles*
- [ ] Blue cheese crumbles — *2 oz; for bold flavor candles*
- [ ] Gruyère, finely shredded — *4 oz; for fondue-inspired candles*
- [ ] Ricotta cheese — *8 oz; for light, creamy bases*
- [ ] Brie — *small wheel; for brie and honey candles*

Oils & Vinegars

- [ ] Truffle oil — *2 oz; for luxury truffle candles*
- [ ] Balsamic vinegar (aged) — *4 oz; for balsamic reduction drizzle*
- [ ] Infused olive oil (garlic or herb) — *4 oz; for savory finishes*
- [ ] Sesame oil (toasted) — *2 oz; for Asian-inspired savory candles*

Nuts, Seeds & Savory Extras

- [ ] Pine nuts — *4 oz; for pesto-inspired candles*
- [ ] Walnuts (halves) — *4 oz; for walnut-blue cheese candles*
- [ ] Marcona almonds — *4 oz; for Spanish-inspired candles*
- [ ] Pumpkin seeds (pepitas) — *2 oz; for garnish*
- [ ] Sunflower seeds — *2 oz; for texture*
- [ ] Flaky sea salt (Maldon or similar) — *for finishing*
- [ ] Black truffle salt — *1 oz; for luxury finishes*
- [ ] Prosciutto or pancetta — *4 oz; for meat-infused candles (use same day)*
- [ ] Breadcrumbs (panko) — *4 oz; for crunchy candle bases*

Perishable Alert

Fresh herbs, soft cheeses, and cured meats are perishable. Buy these only when you're ready to make the specific recipe that calls for them. Most savory candles should be consumed within 2–3 days of preparation and stored refrigerated.

Equipment & Tools Checklist

y tool you need for shaping, pouring, and perfecting your edible
dles.

The right tools make the difference between a frustrating experience and a smooth one. Most items below are standard kitchen equipment you may already own. The candle-specific items (molds and wicks) are the only specialty purchases.

Candle-Specific Supplies

- [ ] Silicone candle molds (pillar style, various sizes) *— set of 4–6*
- [ ] Silicone candle molds (taper style) *— set of 2–4*
- [ ] Silicone candle molds (votive/tea light size) *— set of 6–12*
- [ ] Novelty silicone molds (spheres, stars, flowers) *— 2–3 shapes*
- [ ] Edible wicks (breadstick dough or pretzel sticks) *— see individual recipes*
- [ ] Wick centering tools or skewers *— for keeping wicks straight during setting*
- [ ] Mold release spray (food-safe cooking spray) *— 1 can*

Heating & Melting

- [ ] Double boiler (or heatproof bowl + saucepan) *— essential for melting chocolate and fats*
- [ ] Small saucepan *— for heating cream and sugar syrups*
- [ ] Medium saucepan *— for larger batches*
- [ ] Candy/deep-fry thermometer *— accurate to 1°F; critical for chocolate tempering*
- [ ] Instant-read digital thermometer *— for quick temperature checks*
- [ ] Microwave-safe glass bowls (various sizes) *— for quick melting*

Mixing & Shaping

- [ ] Silicone spatulas (heat-resistant) — *2–3 in different sizes*
- [ ] Wire whisk — *for smooth blending*
- [ ] Hand mixer or stand mixer — *for whipping cream and batters*
- [ ] Mixing bowls (stainless steel, nesting set) — *at least 3 sizes*
- [ ] Piping bags (disposable) — *pack of 12+; for detailed work*
- [ ] Piping tips (round, star, leaf) — *basic set of 6*
- [ ] Offset spatula (small) — *for smoothing surfaces*
- [ ] Palette knife / bench scraper — *for clean edges*
- [ ] Melon baller / cookie scoop set — *for portioning*
- [ ] Rolling pin — *for flattening dough-based elements*
- [ ] Small cookie cutters (round, star, heart) — *for decorative shapes*

Measurement & Precision

- [ ] Digital kitchen scale (grams and ounces) — *accuracy matters for consistent results*
- [ ] Measuring cups (dry, set) — *standard sizes*
- [ ] Measuring cups (liquid, glass) — *1-cup and 2-cup*
- [ ] Measuring spoons (set) — *standard sizes*
- [ ] Timer — *phone timer works fine*

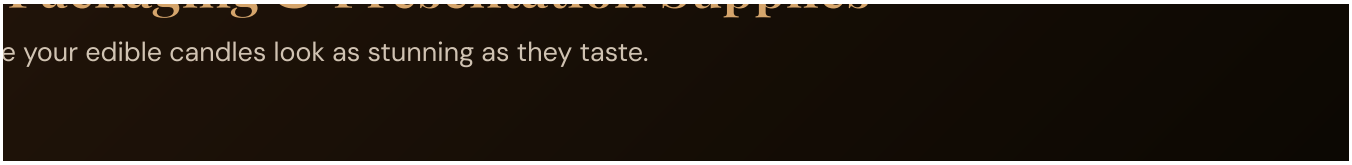
Preparation & Cleanup

- [ ] Parchment paper rolls — *2 rolls; non-stick surface for everything*
- [ ] Wax paper — *1 roll; for wrapping and lining*
- [ ] Plastic wrap — *for covering molds during setting*
- [ ] Aluminum foil — *for lining baking sheets*
- [ ] Baking sheets / sheet pans — *2; flat surface for setting candles*
- [ ] Wire cooling racks — *1–2; for air circulation during setting*
- [ ] Fine mesh strainer / sieve — *for straining infusions*
- [ ] Cheesecloth — *for fine straining of herb infusions*
- [ ] Kitchen towels (lint-free) — *several; for cleanup*
- [ ] Latex or nitrile food-safe gloves — *box; for handling chocolate and delicate work*

Mold Buying Guide

Start with 2–3 basic pillar molds and a set of small votive molds. Silicone is strongly recommended over rigid plastic — it makes unmolding effortless. Food-grade silicone rated to at least 450°F (230°C) is ideal. You can find these at any baking supply or craft store.

Packaging & Presentation Supplies



Whether you're gifting, selling, or simply displaying your creations for a dinner party, presentation elevates the experience. These supplies are optional but highly recommended if you want that "wow" factor.

Display & Serving

- [ ] Small ceramic plates or saucers — *for individual candle display*
- [ ] Mini cake stands — *for elevated presentation*
- [ ] Decorative trays (wood, marble, or slate) — *for grouped displays*
- [ ] Glass cloches / domes — *for dramatic single-candle presentation*
- [ ] Candle holders (ceramic or metal) — *for taper-style edible candles*
- [ ] Tea light holders (glass) — *for votive-size candles*

Gift Boxes & Containers

- [ ] Kraft gift boxes (4x4x4 in.) — *pack of 12; for individual candles*
- [ ] Clear acetate boxes — *pack of 12; for showing off the candle*
- [ ] Rigid gift boxes with magnetic closure — *4–6; for premium gifting*
- [ ] Glass jars with lids (8 oz, wide mouth) — *pack of 6; for jar-style candles*
- [ ] Glass jars with lids (4 oz, wide mouth) — *pack of 12; for mini candles*
- [ ] Tin containers with lids — *pack of 6; for rustic presentation*
- [ ] Cupcake boxes (single and multi-count) — *for votive-size candles*

Wrapping & Cushioning

- [ ] Tissue paper (white, gold, brown) — *for box lining*
- [ ] Shredded paper filler (kraft or cream) — *for cushioning in boxes*
- [ ] Cellophane bags (clear) — *pack of 50; for party favors*
- [ ] Food-safe wax wraps — *for eco-friendly wrapping*
- [ ] Parchment paper squares (pre-cut) — *for individual candle wrapping*

Ribbons, Tags & Labels

- [ ] Satin ribbon (gold, brown, cream) — *3 spools; for box ties*
- [ ] Twine or jute cord (natural) — *1 spool; for rustic wrapping*
- [ ] Hang tags (kraft, blank) — *pack of 24; for labeling flavors*
- [ ] Adhesive labels (round, 1.5 in.) — *for jar and box labels*
- [ ] Adhesive labels (rectangular, 2x3 in.) — *for ingredient lists*
- [ ] Wax seal stamp (candle or initial motif) — *optional luxury touch*
- [ ] Sealing wax sticks (gold or bronze) — *for wax seals on boxes*
- [ ] Metallic marker / calligraphy pen — *for hand-written tags*

Finishing Touches

- [ ] Edible gold dust / luster dust — *for candle surface shimmer*
- [ ] Edible glitter (food-safe) — *for festive candles*
- [ ] Food-safe paint brushes (small) — *for applying gold dust*
- [ ] Toothpicks / bamboo skewers — *for detail work and dipping*
- [ ] Tweezers (food-grade, stainless steel) — *for placing delicate decorations*

> **Allergen Labeling**
> If gifting or selling, always include an ingredients list and allergen warnings on your labels. Common allergens in edible candles include dairy, nuts, wheat (in edible wicks), and soy. This is both a safety consideration and a professional touch.

Where to Find Specialty Items

Where to Find Specialty Items

eral guidance for sourcing harder-to-find ingredients and supplies.

Most items on this checklist are available at standard grocery stores. For the specialty items, here's where to look:

Baking Supply Shops

Your best bet for: silicone molds, chocolate candy melts, piping supplies, edible gold leaf, luster dust, and food coloring. Most mid-size cities have at least one dedicated baking supply retailer. They often carry bulk chocolate at better prices than grocery stores.

Craft Stores

Look here for: candle molds (make sure they're food-safe silicone), gift boxes, ribbons, tags, wax seal supplies, and decorative packaging. The baking aisle in craft stores often overlaps with baking supply shops for molds and decorating tools.

Specialty Grocery Stores

Best for: truffle oil, aged balsamic, specialty cheeses, edible flowers, freeze-dried fruits, za'atar, and imported ingredients. International grocery stores are particularly useful for spices, rose water, and unique flavor ingredients at lower prices.

Farmers' Markets

Ideal for: fresh herbs, artisanal cheeses, raw honey, edible flowers (in season), and locally-produced ingredients. The quality is often superior, and you can ask vendors about sourcing organic or pesticide-free edible flowers.

Online Retailers

The widest selection for: specialty molds, bulk chocolate, cocoa butter, food-grade shea butter, freeze-dried fruit powders, edible flowers, gold leaf, and hard-to-find extracts. Online is often cheaper for bulk purchases. Check reviews for food-grade certification.

Chocolate & Candy Suppliers

Dedicated chocolate suppliers (look for wholesale confectionery distributors in your area) offer couverture chocolate, cocoa butter, and tempering supplies at professional quality and prices. Many sell to hobbyists as well.

Buying in Bulk

If you plan to make candles regularly or in large batches, consider buying coconut oil, chocolate, cocoa butter, and sugar in bulk quantities. The per-unit savings are significant — often 30–50% compared to grocery store prices. Many online retailers offer 5-lb or 10-lb bags of chocolate and cocoa butter specifically for confectionery use.

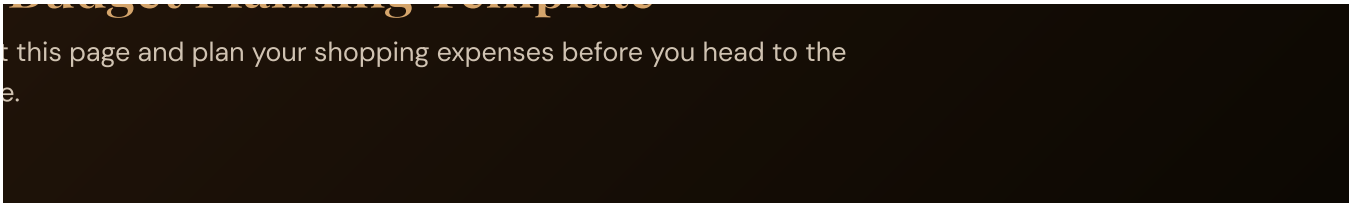
What to Avoid

Do not use candle-making supplies from non-food sources. Standard candle wax, candle dyes, fragrance oils, and traditional wicks are **not edible** and can be toxic. Every ingredient and tool in your edible candle must be food-grade and intended for consumption. When in doubt, check the label for "food-grade" or "food-safe" certification.

Quick-Reference: Where to Find What

ITEM CATEGORY	BEST SOURCE	BACKUP SOURCE
Silicone candle molds	Baking supply shops	Online retailers
Bulk chocolate & cocoa butter	Chocolate suppliers	Online retailers
Edible gold / silver leaf	Baking supply shops	Online retailers
Freeze-dried fruits	Online retailers	Specialty grocery stores
Edible flowers (dried)	Online retailers	Specialty grocery stores
Edible flowers (fresh)	Farmers' markets	Specialty grocery stores
Truffle oil & specialty oils	Specialty grocery stores	Online retailers
Artisanal cheeses	Specialty grocery / farmers' markets	Standard grocery (deli)
Spices & extracts	International grocery stores	Standard grocery stores
Gift boxes & packaging	Craft stores	Online retailers
Piping bags & tips	Baking supply shops	Craft stores
Food-safe gloves	Pharmacy	Online retailers

Budget Planning Template



Use the templates below to estimate and track your spending. Fill in the items you need, estimate the cost, then record the actual cost after shopping. This helps you stay on budget and identify where to save on future batches.

Estimated Starter Budget

A reasonable budget for getting started with base ingredients and basic equipment is **$50–$80**. This covers enough to make your first 5–10 recipes. Adding specialty ingredients for the full Sweet and Savory collections will run an additional $40–$70, though you won't need everything at once. Packaging supplies add $20–$40 depending on your presentation goals.

Shopping Budget — Base Ingredients & Equipment

ITEM	QTY	EST. COST	ACTUAL COST	STORE
	SUBTOTAL:			

Shopping Budget — Sweet Collection

ITEM	QTY	EST. COST	ACTUAL COST	STORE
	SUBTOTAL:			

Shopping Budget — Savory Collection

ITEM	QTY	EST. COST	ACTUAL COST	STORE
	SUBTOTAL:			

Shopping Budget — Packaging & Presentation

ITEM	QTY	EST. COST	ACTUAL COST	STORE
SUBTOTAL:				

Grand Total Summary

CATEGORY	ESTIMATED	ACTUAL
Base Ingredients & Equipment		
Sweet Collection		
Savory Collection		
Packaging & Presentation		
GRAND TOTAL		

Tip: Keep receipts stapled to this page for easy reference when reordering.

Seasonal Shopping Notes

around what's freshest, cheapest, and most available each season.

Some ingredients in the collection are seasonal — either because they're freshest at certain times of year, or because demand drives prices up or down. Use this guide to plan which recipes to make when, and to find smart substitutions when an ingredient is out of season.

SPRING

March – May

Peak availability:

- Fresh herbs (mint, basil, chives, dill)
- Edible flowers (fresh lavender, violets, pansies)
- Strawberries (late spring)
- Meyer lemons
- Rhubarb

Best recipes to make: Floral candles, herb garden candles, lemon and strawberry candles.

Note: Fresh edible flowers are at their best and cheapest now. Stock up and dry extras for later use.

SUMMER

June – August

Peak availability:

- All fresh berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries, blackberries)
- Stone fruits (peach, apricot, nectarine)
- All fresh herbs at peak quality
- Fresh basil (abundant and affordable)
- Tropical fruits (mango, passion fruit)

Best recipes to make: Berry candles, tropical flavors, fresh herb and cheese candles, citrus candles.

Note: Buy extra berries to freeze-dry at home or freeze for later. Chocolate work is trickier in heat — keep your kitchen cool.

AUTUMN

September – November

Peak availability:

- Apples and pears
- Pumpkin and squash (for spice blends)
- Fresh cranberries
- Pecans and walnuts (new harvest)
- Fresh sage and rosemary
- Maple syrup (new production)

Best recipes to make: Spiced candles, maple candles, pecan praline, cranberry, brown butter sage, pumpkin spice.

Note: This is the ideal season for warm-spiced and nut-based candles. Also the best time for gifting candles as holiday season approaches.

WINTER

December – February

Peak availability:

- Citrus fruits (oranges, blood oranges, grapefruit, tangerines)
- Chocolate (holiday sales = best prices)
- Dried fruits and nuts (holiday baking aisle)
- Spices (baking season means fresh stock)
- Candy-making supplies (seasonal availability in stores)

Best recipes to make: Chocolate truffles, citrus candles, gingerbread, peppermint, holiday spice, eggnog candles.

Note: Best chocolate prices of the year. Stock up during post-holiday sales for year-round use. Fresh herbs available year-round in most grocery stores (greenhouse-grown).

Year-Round Availability

These items are available consistently throughout the year and don't require seasonal planning:

Always Available

- All base ingredients (butter, coconut oil, cocoa butter, cream, sugar)
- All chocolate and cocoa products
- All dried spices and extracts
- All cheeses (grocery deli section)
- Freeze-dried fruits (online or specialty stores)
- Dried edible flowers (online)
- All equipment and tools
- All packaging supplies

Seasonal Substitution Tips

- Fresh berries out of season: use freeze-dried instead
- Fresh herbs in winter: use 1/3 the amount of dried herbs
- Fresh edible flowers: use dried edible flowers year-round
- Fresh citrus zest: bottled zest works in a pinch
- Fresh tropical fruits: frozen purees available year-round
- Seasonal nuts at high prices: buy in bulk during autumn harvest

Smart Seasonal Shopping Strategy

Buy seasonal ingredients at peak freshness and preserve them for year-round use. Fresh herbs can be infused into oils and frozen in ice cube trays. Berries can be freeze-dried or dehydrated at home. Nuts keep for months in the freezer. Citrus zest can be dried and stored in airtight containers. This approach gives you the best flavor at the lowest cost, no matter what time of year you decide to make a recipe.



EDIBLE CANDLES — THE GOURMET COLLECTION

You're Ready to Shop!

With this checklist in hand, you have everything you need to stock your kitchen confidently. Start with the essentials, pick your first recipe, and enjoy the creative process of making gourmet edible candles.

Next Step

Open the main recipe collection and choose your first candle to create.